

Non-SC Mukhiya Survey - LSE Dissertation

Module 0 — Introduction and verbal consent

Enumerator: Namaste! My name is __, I am speaking from Patna from CK Singh Management. We are doing a research with a student from the London School of Economics. Through this survey, we want to learn about the experience of working as a Mukhiya in Bihar—what is your daily life like in this position, and what challenges do you face in your social and political lives that hinder your work. We also want to inform you that we are not affiliated with any government organization, nor is this an evaluation of you as a Mukhiya. This is a survey, primarily intended to hear your experience from your own perspective. The information provided in this survey is kept confidential and will not be shared with anyone. It will be used solely for this research.

Do you agree to take part in this interview?

☐ Yes

☐ No

Enumerator: thank the respondent and end the interview here.

Module A — Respondent and panchayat profile

» A1. Respondent identification

Name of the elected mukhiya

Enumerator: record from the sample frame and confirm with the respondent.

Unique ID of the respondent:

Enter the unique id of the respondent from the sample list.

Re-enter the Unique ID of the respondent.

Are you the elected mukhiya yourself, or answering on their behalf?

☐ I am the elected mukhiya

☐ I am answering on behalf of the elected mukhiya

Gender of the elected mukhiya

Don't ask this question. Only record from your judgement.

☐ Male

☐ Female

Relationship to the elected mukhiya

- | | | |
|---|---|---------------------------------------|
| ☐ Husband | ☐ Father | ☐ Father-in-law |
| ☐ Son | ☐ Brother | ☐ Brother-in-law |
| ☐ Other male relative | ☐ Other female relative | ☐ Other (specify) |

Other relationship (specify)

Gender of respondent

Don't ask this question. Only record from your judgement.

- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female

Caste category of the elected mukhiya

- | | | |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|--|
| ☐ General | ☐ BC-1 (EBC) | ☐ BC-2 (BC) |
| ☐ Scheduled Caste | ☐ Scheduled Tribe | ☐ Other (please specify) |

Specify why participant doesn't belong to listed caste category:

Caste / jāti of the elected mukhiya

Caste / jāti of the elected mukhiya (name)

» A2. Panchayat characteristics**Number of revenue villages**

Approximate total population

Approximate SC population share

- ☐ Less than 10%
- ☐ 10–15%
- ☐ 15–20%
- ☐ More than 20%
- ☐ Not sure

Do you belong to the main village of the panchayat?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Which caste group is most dominant / influential in your panchayat?

» A3. Tenure and background

How many times have you stood for election?

How many terms as mukhiya (including current)?

Highest education completed

- | | | |
|---|---|---|
| ☐ No formal schooling | ☐ Primary | ☐ Middle |
| ☐ Secondary (10th) | ☐ Higher secondary (12th) | ☐ Graduate or above |

Main household income source

- | | | |
|---|--|--------------------------------------|
| ☐ Agricultural labour on others' land | ☐ Own cultivation | ☐ Small business |
| ☐ Salaried job | ☐ Government scheme work | ☐ Other |

Module B — Independence and authority in office

Has anyone in your family held a panchayat position before you (mukhiya, ward member, sarpanch)?

One or more options may be selected.

- ☐ No one
- ☐ Father
- ☐ Father-in-law
- ☐ Spouse
- ☐ Sibling
- ☐ Other relative

Did you contest with the support of a political party / leader?

- ☐ Yes, formally
- ☐ Yes, informally
- ☐ No, independent

(Read aloud) "The next questions are about how work gets done in your panchayat. There are no right or wrong answers. For each task, please tell me who most often does it."

Preparing cheques and financial documents

- ☐ I do it myself ☐ I do it with help from family ☐ The panchayat secretary does it
- ☐ The former mukhiya or their family member does it ☐ The deputy mukhiya does it
- ☐ A family member does it for me ☐ Someone else (specify)

Someone else (specify)

Deciding the beneficiary list for housing and other schemes

- ☐ I do it myself ☐ I do it with help from family ☐ The panchayat secretary does it
- ☐ The former mukhiya or their family member does it ☐ The deputy mukhiya does it
- ☐ A family member does it for me ☐ Someone else (specify)

Someone else (specify)

Chairing and running the Gram Sabha meeting

- ☐ I do it myself ☐ I do it with help from family ☐ The panchayat secretary does it
- ☐ The former mukhiya or their family member does it ☐ The deputy mukhiya does it
- ☐ A family member does it for me ☐ Someone else (specify)

Someone else (specify)

Meeting the BDO / other officials for panchayat work

- ☐ I do it myself ☐ I do it with help from family ☐ The panchayat secretary does it
- ☐ The former mukhiya or their family member does it ☐ The deputy mukhiya does it
- ☐ A family member does it for me ☐ Someone else (specify)

Someone else (specify)

Representing the panchayat at block-level meetings

- ☐ I do it myself ☐ I do it with help from family ☐ The panchayat secretary does it
- ☐ The former mukhiya or their family member does it ☐ The deputy mukhiya does it
- ☐ A family member does it for me ☐ Someone else (specify)

Someone else (specify)

Deciding which development works get priority

- ☐ I do it myself
 ☐ I do it with help from family
 ☐ The panchayat secretary does it
 ☐ The former mukhiya or their family member does it
 ☐ The deputy mukhiya does it
 ☐ A family member does it for me
 ☐ Someone else (specify)

Someone else (specify)

Attending to villagers who come with complaints or requests

- ☐ I do it myself
 ☐ I do it with help from family
 ☐ The panchayat secretary does it
 ☐ The former mukhiya or their family member does it
 ☐ The deputy mukhiya does it
 ☐ A family member does it for me
 ☐ Someone else (specify)

Someone else (specify)

When an important decision must be made, who makes the final call?

- ☐ I do, independently
 ☐ I do, after consulting others
 ☐ I and the deputy / others jointly
 ☐ Others decide and I formalise it
 ☐ Others decide entirely

» B2. Self-efficacy

Enumerator: read the options for each statement — Strongly agree / Agree / Neutral / Disagree / Strongly disagree.

I am able to get my decisions implemented even when powerful people disagree.

☐ Strongly disagree
 ☐ Disagree
 ☐ Neutral
 ☐ Agree
 ☐ Strongly agree

When someone creates obstacles, I am usually able to find a way to get the work done.

☐ Strongly disagree
 ☐ Disagree
 ☐ Neutral
 ☐ Agree
 ☐ Strongly agree

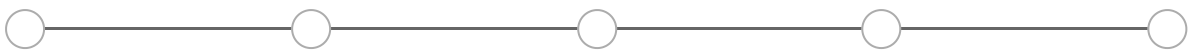
I am confident in my ability to achieve most of the goals I set for myself.

☐ Strongly disagree
 ☐ Disagree
 ☐ Neutral
 ☐ Agree
 ☐ Strongly agree

I can stand my ground when someone tries to pressure me into a decision.

☐ Strongly disagree
 ☐ Disagree
 ☐ Neutral
 ☐ Agree
 ☐ Strongly agree

I feel confident representing my panchayat before government officials.



Strongly disagree Disagree Neutral Agree Strongly agree

Enumerator: not a test — record what is known; 'Not sure' is fine. Do NOT read options aloud on knowledge items.

Do you know whether the mukhiya can call a Gram Sabha meeting on their own?

Do not read options; code the answer.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not sure

Do you know what a GPDP is?

Do not read options; code the answer.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not sure

Do you know what type the 15th Finance Commission fund is?

Options may be read aloud if needed.

- ☐ Tied
- ☐ Untied
- ☐ Both
- ☐ Not sure

Are you aware of how many standing committees your GP has?

Enter the number. Leave blank if not known.

Who gives birth-death certificates to villagers?

Do not read options; code the answer.

- ☐ Mukhiya
- ☐ Secretary
- ☐ Both
- ☐ Not sure

How are PMAY-G beneficiaries mainly selected?

Do not read options; code the answer.

- ☐ Survey-based list verified by Gram Sabha ☐ Mukhiya chooses freely
- ☐ BDO alone chooses ☐ Other ☐ Not sure

Module C — Attitudes and beliefs about caste and reservation

(Read aloud) "Now I would like your views on some panchayat-governance issues. People have very different opinions and there are no right or wrong answers. Please answer as frankly as you can — your answers are fully confidential."

Some capable people miss the chance to be mukhiya because a seat is reserved.

- | | | |
|---|--------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Strongly disagree | ☐ Disagree | ☐ Neutral |
| ☐ Agree | ☐ Strongly agree | ☐ Prefer not to say |

SC mukhiyas need more help running the panchayat than others.

- | | | |
|---|--------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Strongly disagree | ☐ Disagree | ☐ Neutral |
| ☐ Agree | ☐ Strongly agree | ☐ Prefer not to say |

SC candidates who become mukhiya through reservation are usually not capable.

- | | | |
|---|--------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Strongly disagree | ☐ Disagree | ☐ Neutral |
| ☐ Agree | ☐ Strongly agree | ☐ Prefer not to say |

SC mukhiyas would face fewer problems if they cooperated more with established village leaders.

- | | | |
|---|--------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Strongly disagree | ☐ Disagree | ☐ Neutral |
| ☐ Agree | ☐ Strongly agree | ☐ Prefer not to say |

Some people say SC mukhiyas find it harder to deal with officials. Do you agree?

- | | | |
|---|--------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Strongly disagree | ☐ Disagree | ☐ Neutral |
| ☐ Agree | ☐ Strongly agree | ☐ Prefer not to say |

SC candidates who become mukhiya through reservation only work in SC/ST hamlets.

- | | | |
|---|--------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Strongly disagree | ☐ Disagree | ☐ Neutral |
| ☐ Agree | ☐ Strongly agree | ☐ Prefer not to say |

SC mukhiyas usually misuse their position.

- | | | |
|---|--------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Strongly disagree | ☐ Disagree | ☐ Neutral |
| ☐ Agree | ☐ Strongly agree | ☐ Prefer not to say |

Reservation of mukhiya seats for Scheduled Castes is bad for village democracy.

- | | | |
|---|--------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Strongly disagree | ☐ Disagree | ☐ Neutral |
| ☐ Agree | ☐ Strongly agree | ☐ Prefer not to say |

Some people say whether someone is a good mukhiya has nothing to do with caste. Do you agree?

- | | | |
|---|--------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Strongly disagree | ☐ Disagree | ☐ Neutral |
| ☐ Agree | ☐ Strongly agree | ☐ Prefer not to say |

The SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act is unjust for non-SC/ST communities.

- | | | |
|---|--------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Strongly disagree | ☐ Disagree | ☐ Neutral |
| ☐ Agree | ☐ Strongly agree | ☐ Prefer not to say |

There are a lot of fake cases filed under the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act.

- | | | |
|---|--------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Strongly disagree | ☐ Disagree | ☐ Neutral |
| ☐ Agree | ☐ Strongly agree | ☐ Prefer not to say |

Module D — Conjoint experiment

(Read aloud) "Now I will describe some imaginary mukhiyas from a neighbouring area, two at a time. There are no right or wrong answers. For each pair I will ask which one you would find easier to work with. I know these are just descriptions — please tell me your honest first reaction."

» Task 1

Here are two mukhiyas.

Mukhiya 1: a

Mukhiya 2: a

If you had to work with one of them on a shared block-level matter, which would you find easier to cooperate with?

1. Read the description of Mukhiyas once again.

2. If the respondent rates both mukhiyas similarly, ask them who they prefer slightly higher.

- ☐ Mukhiya 1
- ☐ Mukhiya 2

Imagine you cannot run for the next election — which of them would you want to be the mukhiya of your GP?

1. Read the description of Mukhiyas once again.

2. If the respondent rates both mukhiyas similarly, ask them who they prefer slightly higher.

- ☐ Mukhiya 1
- ☐ Mukhiya 2

» Task 2

Here are two mukhiyas.

Mukhiya 1: a

Mukhiya 2: a

If you had to work with one of them on a shared block-level matter, which would you find easier to cooperate with?

1. Read the description of Mukhiyas once again.

2. If the respondent rates both mukhiyas similarly, ask them who they prefer slightly higher.

☐ Mukhiya 1

☐ Mukhiya 2

Imagine you cannot run for the next election — which of them would you want to be the mukhiya of your GP?

1. Read the description of Mukhiyas once again.

2. If the respondent rates both mukhiyas similarly, ask them who they prefer slightly higher.

☐ Mukhiya 1

☐ Mukhiya 2

» Task 3

Here are two mukhiyas.

Mukhiya 1: a

Mukhiya 2: a

If you had to work with one of them on a shared block-level matter, which would you find easier to cooperate with?

1. Read the description of Mukhiyas once again.

2. If the respondent rates both mukhiyas similarly, ask them who they prefer slightly higher.

☐ Mukhiya 1

☐ Mukhiya 2

Imagine you cannot run for the next election — which of them would you want to be the mukhiya of your GP?

1. Read the description of Mukhiyas once again.

2. If the respondent rates both mukhiyas similarly, ask them who they prefer slightly higher.

☐ Mukhiya 1

☐ Mukhiya 2

» Task 4

Here are two mukhiyas.

Mukhiya 1: a

Mukhiya 2: a

If you had to work with one of them on a shared block-level matter, which would you find easier to cooperate with?

1. Read the description of Mukhiyas once again.

2. If the respondent rates both mukhiyas similarly, ask them who they prefer slightly higher.

☐ Mukhiya 1

☐ Mukhiya 2

Imagine you cannot run for the next election — which of them would you want to be the mukhiya of your GP?

1. Read the description of Mukhiyas once again.

2. If the respondent rates both mukhiyas similarly, ask them who they prefer slightly higher.

☐ Mukhiya 1

☐ Mukhiya 2

» Task 5

Here are two mukhiyas.

Mukhiya 1: a

Mukhiya 2: a

If you had to work with one of them on a shared block-level matter, which would you find easier to cooperate with?

1. Read the description of Mukhiyas once again.

2. If the respondent rates both mukhiyas similarly, ask them who they prefer slightly higher.

☐ Mukhiya 1

☐ Mukhiya 2

Imagine you cannot run for the next election — which of them would you want to be the mukhiya of your GP?

1. Read the description of Mukhiyas once again.

2. If the respondent rates both mukhiyas similarly, ask them who they prefer slightly higher.

☐ Mukhiya 1

☐ Mukhiya 2

Module E — Resource allocation experiment

(Read aloud) "Now imagine a situation — this is just an imaginary example. Suppose you were given a prize of Rs 1,00,000. In a neighbouring area you do not know, four different people each have a chance of becoming mukhiya. Imagine you could, if you wished, use some of this money to reduce the chance of any of them becoming mukhiya — or keep all of it. This is not about corruption or buying votes; it is only a hypothetical exercise. There is no right answer."

This person is . How much of your Rs 1,00,000, if anything, would you use to reduce their chance of becoming mukhiya?

-

- | | | |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------|
| ☐ 0 | ☐ 5000 | ☐ 10000 |
| ☐ 15000 | ☐ 20000 | ☐ 25000 |
| ☐ 30000 | ☐ 35000 | ☐ 40000 |
| ☐ 45000 | ☐ 50000 | ☐ 55000 |
| ☐ 60000 | ☐ 65000 | ☐ 70000 |
| ☐ 75000 | ☐ 80000 | ☐ 85000 |
| ☐ 90000 | ☐ 95000 | ☐ 100000 |

This person is . How much of your Rs 1,00,000, if anything, would you use to reduce their chance of becoming mukhiya?

-

- | | | |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------|
| ☐ 0 | ☐ 5000 | ☐ 10000 |
| ☐ 15000 | ☐ 20000 | ☐ 25000 |
| ☐ 30000 | ☐ 35000 | ☐ 40000 |
| ☐ 45000 | ☐ 50000 | ☐ 55000 |
| ☐ 60000 | ☐ 65000 | ☐ 70000 |
| ☐ 75000 | ☐ 80000 | ☐ 85000 |
| ☐ 90000 | ☐ 95000 | ☐ 100000 |

This person is . How much of your Rs 1,00,000, if anything, would you use to reduce their chance of becoming mukhiya?

-

- | | | |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------|
| ☐ 0 | ☐ 5000 | ☐ 10000 |
| ☐ 15000 | ☐ 20000 | ☐ 25000 |
| ☐ 30000 | ☐ 35000 | ☐ 40000 |
| ☐ 45000 | ☐ 50000 | ☐ 55000 |
| ☐ 60000 | ☐ 65000 | ☐ 70000 |
| ☐ 75000 | ☐ 80000 | ☐ 85000 |
| ☐ 90000 | ☐ 95000 | ☐ 100000 |

This person is . How much of your Rs 1,00,000, if anything, would you use to reduce their chance of becoming mukhiya?

-

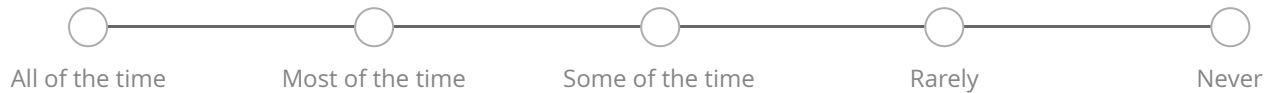
- | | | |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------|
| ☐ 0 | ☐ 5000 | ☐ 10000 |
| ☐ 15000 | ☐ 20000 | ☐ 25000 |
| ☐ 30000 | ☐ 35000 | ☐ 40000 |
| ☐ 45000 | ☐ 50000 | ☐ 55000 |
| ☐ 60000 | ☐ 65000 | ☐ 70000 |
| ☐ 75000 | ☐ 80000 | ☐ 85000 |
| ☐ 90000 | ☐ 95000 | ☐ 100000 |

Module F — Well-being (WHO-5)

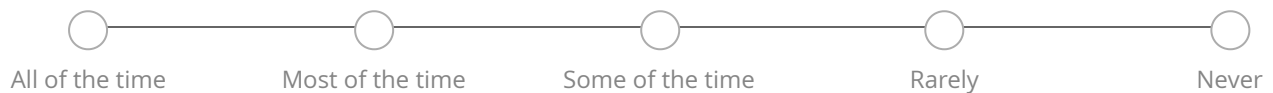
(Read aloud) "Now a few general questions about how you have been feeling in the last two weeks." Read the scale: 5 = All of the time, 4 = Most of the time, 3 = Some of the time, 2 = Rarely, 1 = Never.

» Over the last two weeks...

I have felt cheerful and in good spirits.



I have felt calm and relaxed.



I have felt active and vigorous.



I woke up feeling fresh and rested.



My daily life has been filled with things that interest me.



Module G — Closing

Is there anything about being a mukhiya that you feel is important and I have not asked?

Enumerator: thank warmly, reconfirm confidentiality.

Enumerator: complete the following yourself — do not ask the respondent.

How well did the respondent understand the questions?

- ☐ Fully
- ☐ Mostly
- ☐ Somewhat
- ☐ Poorly

How sincerely did the respondent answer?

- ☐ Fully sincere
- ☐ Mostly
- ☐ Somewhat
- ☐ Doubtful

Was the conjoint/allocation task understood, or did the respondent struggle to hold the profiles in mind?

- ☐ Understood well
- ☐ Some difficulty
- ☐ Major difficulty

Please enter any other comments regarding this survey.
